

Response to a claim

I strongly disagree with the claim that getting a college degree is not as important as most people think it is.

Intro:

- I think that college is a very beneficial environment where you learn and grow financially, socially, culturally, and in every other way.
- I'm going to present several arguments to base my claim.

Body:

1. Starting from plain statistics, while high school graduates can find jobs, those are usually much lower paying jobs. Government polls show that college graduates with merely a bachelor's degree earn almost twice the amount high school graduates earn on average.
 - a. Over a lifetime, an average college graduate makes 1.2 million dollars more than a high school graduate.
 - b. Can you make money without a college degree? Of course, but you are much less likely to earn nearly as much as a college graduate.
 - c. That simply comes from the fact that our industry is built in a way that rewards innovation, creation, and the advancement of technology, and those are things you simply cannot do without some kind of higher education.
2. Secondly, people underestimate college education thinking all they teach you is just things you could learn on your own.
 - a. But every self-respecting institution has a mission much bigger than that.
 - b. College students are taught to think independently and critically.
 - c. College essentially teaches you to create and innovate, by making you question the very fabric of our reality, causing college graduates to be more likely to know how to think critically and advance our society forward.

3. Lastly, I think that college is more than just important, it's essential.
 - a. College gives you the opportunity to gradually get out of the bubble you used to live in with your family and actually aspire to reach higher than what you've been presented so far.
 - b. The college environment also pulls you out of your local scene, and gives you a perspective to meet people who are from completely different worlds.
 - c. Universities mix people from all over the country and sometimes the world, which is to itself a highly significant aspect of college, teaching us how to view people who are different, and don't come from the exact same place as we did.

Conclusion:

- I do want to emphasize that everything I mention that college gives you is possible to get without going to college. High school graduates have done incredible things in the world.
- My point is not that high school education is bad and that college is irreplaceable. It's that college education and environment gives you a structured place to gradually leave home, develop your thinking, and understand reality better, which is something that I think is very important.